

Advanced Filter is a more sophisticated version of the standard AutoFilter. While standard filters allow you to pick values from a dropdown, **Advanced Filter** uses a separate "Criteria Range" to perform complex filtering that involves multiple conditions, unique records, or "OR" logic.

1. Core Capabilities

Advanced Filter is particularly useful for engineering datasets or large "Sales data" lists because it can:

- **Filter in Place:** Hide rows that do not meet your criteria within the original table.
 - **Copy to Another Location:** Extract the filtered results and paste them into a completely different part of the sheet or a new worksheet.
 - **Unique Records Only:** Quickly remove or filter out duplicates to ensure data integrity.
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2. Setting Up the Criteria Range

To use Advanced Filter, you must set up a small table above or to the side of your main data.

- **Exact Headers:** The headers in your criteria range must match the headers in your main table exactly.
 - **"AND" Logic:** If you place criteria on the **same row**, Excel treats them as "AND" (e.g., City = "Hubli" **AND** Salary > 50000).
 - **"OR" Logic:** If you place criteria on **different rows**, Excel treats them as "OR" (e.g., City = "Hubli" **OR** City = "Mysore").
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3. Using Wildcards

Advanced Filter supports wildcards for searching text strings within cells:

- **Asterisk (*):** Represents any number of characters (e.g., M* finds "Mysore," "Mangalore," and "Marker").
 - **Question Mark (?):** Represents a single character (e.g., H?bli finds "Hubli").
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4. Workflow to Apply Advanced Filter

1. **Prepare Criteria:** Create your criteria table with identical headers.
2. **Access Tool:** Go to the **Data** tab and select **Advanced** (next to the standard Filter icon).
3. **Define Ranges:**
 - **List Range:** Select your entire main data table.
 - **Criteria Range:** Select your small criteria table (including the headers).

4. **Action:** Choose "Filter the list, in-place" or "Copy to another location".
5. **Click OK:** Excel will execute the filter based on your logic.

5. Integration with Other Features

- **Data Validation:** You can use a dropdown list in your criteria range to make the Advanced Filter more user-friendly and prevent typos.
- **Pivot Tables:** Advanced filtering is often a great first step to clean a dataset before summarizing it in a **Pivot Table**.
- **Absolute References:** If you use formulas within your criteria (like comparing a cell to an average), use absolute references to keep the logic stable.